

Smart Fit Frames

From customer observation to a commercially launched physical product for fabric businesses.

PROJECT SNAPSHOT

Contribution Product Discovery & Product Strategy — product thinking, insight discovery, documentation, and translating user requirements into product direction.	Duration 6 months from exploration to commercial launch.
Customer Fabric wholesalers, retailers, and fabric businesses.	Product 12 × 16-inch acrylic frame for garment-fabric visualization.

COMMERCIAL SIGNALS

INR 6L Reported revenue across six months	INR 595 Approx. full landed cost per frame	20–30 Fabric owners approached	12 × 16 in Final product dimensions
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Portfolio positioning

This document presents Smart Fit Frames as a product portfolio project. It focuses on customer discovery, problem framing, product decisions, MVP scope, commercial thinking, and learning—not on claiming sole ownership of the full execution.

Prepared for APM / Product Management applications

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A practical opportunity identified through market observation

VIBEWINN began with a broader idea: help businesses advertise themselves through useful physical products and connect with more customers. During exploration, the team identified a more specific need among fabric wholesalers and retailers: a useful way to improve the buyer experience and help customers visualize what fabric might look like after tailoring.

The observed problem

Fabric buyers often evaluate plain fabric without being able to easily imagine the finished garment. Fabric businesses could explain possible outcomes, but the buying conversation lacked a simple, tangible visualization aid.

Existing alternatives and implications

Alternative	Observed limitation	Implication
Cardboard frames	Perceived as low-quality, less durable, and less visually appealing.	Use a more premium and durable material.
Glass-based display	Costly and vulnerable to breakage.	Balance appearance, cost, and practicality.
No visualization aid	Customers may struggle to imagine a tailored result from plain fabric.	Create a simple physical aid for the selling conversation.

Target users and stakeholders

Primary customer Fabric wholesalers and retailers who purchase and use the frame.	End user Fabric buyers who need help visualizing a possible tailored outcome.
Internal stakeholders Team members handling sourcing, design, manufacturing coordination, and sales.	Commercial decision-maker The fabric business owner evaluating usefulness, customization, durability, and price.

Problem statement

How might we help fabric businesses make plain fabric easier to visualize as a potential tailored garment through a product that is simple, attractive, durable, and affordable for everyday commercial use?

Use a prototype to learn what customers value before expanding scope

Research approach

The team took an early prototype to fabric owners and spoke with approximately 20–30 fabric owners. The goal was to understand whether the concept was useful in the fabric-selling environment and what changes would make it more relevant to prospective customers.

Research signals and product implications

Signal	What was learned	Implication
Concept reception	Fabric owners generally liked the idea when shown the prototype.	Continue with a focused physical MVP.
Customization demand	Owners wanted company logos and customized garment designs.	Treat customization as a commercial requirement and future capability.
Format preference	Customer preference led the team from a larger frame toward a shorter format.	Converge on a 12 × 16-inch frame.
Visual clarity	The initial black background did not make the trouser design stand out sufficiently over fabric.	Change the background to white for better contrast.
Market awareness	The product appeared unfamiliar or differentiated in the observed customer environment.	Demonstration and explanation would be important in sales.

Evidence boundaries

- The research provided directional validation: the concept was understandable, useful, and improvable to the fabric owners approached.
- The research was not a statistically representative study and did not establish a market-wide demand estimate.
- Exact conversion, customer count, willingness to pay, repeat-order rate, and unit volume were not formally documented.

Discovery takeaway

The strongest signal was that fabric owners could understand the value of a tangible prototype and identify concrete improvements—especially customization, format, and visual contrast.

Choose the smallest product that can test the core value proposition

Product concept

Smart Fit Frames is a 12 × 16-inch acrylic frame with a laser-printed garment design—such as a shirt, trouser, or suit—on its surface. The remaining area is white. When placed over plain fabric, the frame helps the buyer imagine how the material might look when tailored into that garment.

1. Plain fabric Start with a fabric sample.	2. Position the frame Place the acrylic frame over the fabric.	3. Visualize Use the garment design to imagine a possible tailored outcome.
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Key product decisions

Decision	Reasoning
Acrylic base material	Balances visual appeal, durability, and manufacturability better than the observed cardboard and glass alternatives.
Physical, simple MVP	The immediate need was a tangible visualization aid, not a complex digital workflow.
12 × 16-inch format	Customer preference supported a shorter, more manageable frame.
White background	Improved contrast after the initial black background reduced design visibility.
Garment-specific designs	Different outlines make the frame relevant to different fabric-buying situations.

Future idea, not MVP: LCD visualization

An LCD-based version was considered only as a future direction. It was not developed or included in the MVP because it would add cost and technical complexity before the core value proposition had been sufficiently proven.

Product strategy principle

Start with the smallest physical intervention that improves the customer conversation. Validate usefulness and commercial demand before investing in a more complex visualization system.

Convert the product concept into something customers can buy and use

MVP boundaries

Included	Not included
12 × 16-inch acrylic frame	LCD or screen-based visualization
Laser-printed garment designs	Complex digital wardrobe or measurement workflow
White background for contrast	Large-scale customization platform
Direct sales and bulk orders	Automated analytics dashboard

Business and operating model

Customer acquisition Direct conversations with fabric wholesalers and retailers.	Revenue model Direct sales per frame and bulk orders.
Cost signal Approximate full landed cost: INR 595 per frame.	Execution Team coordination across sourcing, design, manufacturing, and sales.

Reported commercial outcome

Outcome	Evidence / qualification
Product launched	Reported as completed during the six-month project period.
Approximately INR 6 lakh in revenue	Reported revenue across six months; no transaction-level breakdown was provided.
Positive customer response	Fabric owners generally liked the product; repeat orders and customer promotion were reported.
Customization interest	Customers requested company logos and customized designs.

My contribution

I focused on product discovery and product strategy: identifying the user problem, interpreting fabric-owner requirements, documenting the concept, shaping product decisions, and helping define what the product should be. Other team members handled sourcing, design, and sales execution.

What this project taught me about building products

1. Start with the customer problem, not the first solution

The original direction was broad. Speaking with fabric businesses helped narrow the opportunity to a specific customer problem: improving how buyers visualize fabric as a possible finished garment. This reinforced the importance of problem discovery before committing to a product format.

2. Use prototypes to make feedback concrete

A tangible prototype made the idea easier for fabric owners to understand and react to. Instead of asking customers to evaluate an abstract concept, the team could observe reactions and collect specific requests around format, customization, and visual clarity.

3. Prioritize the core value proposition

The decision to keep the MVP physical and simple avoided premature investment in a more complex LCD-based concept. The product focused first on one job: helping a fabric buyer visualize a possible garment outcome.

4. Treat design details as product decisions

The change from a black background to a white background was a small but meaningful iteration. It improved contrast and made the garment design easier to see over fabric. This showed how visual clarity can directly affect product usefulness.

5. Separate evidence from assumptions

The project produced a reported commercial signal—approximately INR 6 lakh in revenue across six months—but several product metrics were not formally tracked. A stronger product process would connect customer feedback to measurable adoption, repeat usage, conversion, and margin data.

Measurement gaps and next steps

- Record units sold, paying customers, average order value, repeat-order rate, and gross margin.
- Track which garment designs and customer segments generate the strongest demand.
- Measure whether the frame improves buyer confidence, conversion, or fabric sales.
- Test logo customization, design variants, and distributor-led distribution.
- Revisit advanced digital or LCD visualization only if demand and economics justify it.

APM portfolio takeaway

This project demonstrates practical APM capabilities: customer discovery, problem framing, insight synthesis, hypothesis formation, MVP definition, prioritization, trade-off analysis, product documentation, stakeholder coordination, iteration, and commercial thinking.

Skills demonstrated

• Customer discovery	• Problem framing	• User insight synthesis
• Hypothesis formation	• MVP definition	• Product prioritization
• Trade-off analysis	• Product documentation	• Stakeholder coordination
• Commercial thinking	• Iteration	• Outcome orientation